

Rave reviews

A review is a piece of writing that provides a focused description and evaluation of an event or a publication, such as a book or a movie. It is much more subjective than an analysis, and is therefore written in the first person, with many personal opinions.

The travel website **TripAdvisor** contains more than **75 million** consumer **reviews** and opinions.

Sneak preview

The first part of a review should give a short summary of the movie, book, show, or other event without giving everything away. It should give the reader a general idea of what it is about.

The good and the bad

The middle part of a review should go into more detail about the strengths and weaknesses of the subject. It might discuss the acting in a play, the quality of writing in a book, or the use of special effects in a movie. It is important to back up any comments with examples.

- An analysis should be **structured** clearly, using **paragraphs**. Discuss one point of view first, followed by the other. Finally, come to a **balanced conclusion**.
- When writing a review, think about the **audience** and what they **want to know** about the subject being reviewed.

Movie preview

TAKE TO THE FLOOR 2

Take to the Floor 2 is the latest in a series of teen dance dramas to spin into theaters. As usual, the story focuses on two young dancers from the opposite sides of town. When street kid Chad wins a scholarship to a prestigious dance school, he finds it hard to fit in. Then, one day, he catches the eye of ballet dancer Ellie, who is wowed by his moves.

Many of the dance scenes are spectacular, from a rooftop tango in the pouring rain to a shopping mall salsa extravaganza. The cast members are all highly trained movers; however, their acting skills were left at the stage door. Ellie and Chad fail to bring their sizzling dance-floor chemistry into the dialogue, which is disappointing.



The rooftop tango scene is stunning and very moving.

Take to the Floor 2 is nothing new; the plot certainly doesn't offer any surprises. However, the film is saved by its show-stopping dance scenes and pumping soundtrack. Overall, it's incredibly fun to watch, even if you end up feeling like you've seen it all before.

The verdict

The final paragraph in a review should be a summarizing statement about the subject, and an overall recommendation—a final judgment on whether the subject is worth watching, seeing, or reading.